

altairsim — The MITS 8800bt -- an Altair with a Turnkey Module

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The 8800b "turnkey" system had no front panel. One S-100 board -- the **Systems Turnkey Module** -- carried the boot PROM, the terminal serial port, the sense switches, and an Auto-Start circuit that booted the machine the moment you switched it on. These two files are that machine, booting CP/M two ways.

```
cd examples/turnkey
altairsim floppy.toml    # -> 56K CP/M 2.2b off an 88-DCDD floppy, A>
altairsim hdisk.toml    # -> 48K CP/M 2.2b off an 88-HDSK hard disk, A0>
```

Both are deltas on the built-in `turnkey` machine (`altairsim turnkey`), which is the 8800bt itself: the Turnkey Module, an 8080, an 88-DCDD floppy controller, the Host Bridge, and **64K** of RAM. See `docs/boards/mits-turnkey.md` and `reference/MITS Turn Key Board.md`.

What the Turnkey Module does that a front panel does not

- **It boots itself.** There is no front panel to toggle a bootstrap in from. `RUN 0000` starts the CPU at address 0, and the Auto-Start circuit **jams a JMP onto the bus** -- `C3 00 hi`, where `hi` is the START ADDR switches -- so the first three fetches run the boot PROM. `floppy.toml` leaves the switches at FF00 (DBL, the floppy loader); `hdsk.toml` moves them to FC00 (HDBL, the hard-disk loader) and drops HDBL into the board's socket L1.
- **The boot PROM gets out of the way.** The PROM at FC00-FFFF *shadows* RAM for reads until the first `IN` from port FE/FF, then vanishes, so the machine has the full 64K of RAM. On a front-panel Altair the RAM stops at DFFF to leave room for the PROM; here it does not have to.
- **The console and the sense switches are on the same card.** The 6850 SIO is at 0x10 (compatible with an 88-2SIO's Port A), and the sense switches answer port FF -- so this machine carries no separate `2sio` and no `fp`.

The disk images are borrowed

`floppy.toml` boots the flagship CP/M floppy from `../cpm`, and `hdsk.toml` boots the platter from `../hdsk`, rather than shipping third and fourth copies of two large images. If you move this folder somewhere on its own, copy those images in beside it (or point the `mount =` paths at

wherever you put them). Both disks are mounted read/write; copy them before testing writes in anger, or add `readonly = true` to the drive.